

CivicSphere

Making political discourse friendly, accessible and impactful

[Visit our website](#)

The Problem



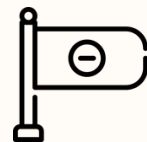
Impersonal and non-specific traditional channels

Does not answer user-specific queries with local politics and disengaging



Fragmented political information

Difficulty in accessing reliable political information in consolidated manner



Inaccuracy, toxic and biased information

Citizen disengagement due to breach of trust due to toxic, misleading and biased content



Lack of accessible, neutral and compliant discussion forums

Lack of simpler, accessible and neutral platform that avoids user profiling

Its Impact

Lack of clear understanding

Citizens are left with incoherent
local political understanding

Marginalization of underrepresented people

Reduced engagement from people with
disadvantaged backgrounds

Weaker community engagement

Reduction in morale poses trust on
political processes

Ineffective action by local bodies

Lack of inclusion and weakened
participation results in weaker changes in
political landscape for civilian welfare

Our Solution



Accessible, inclusive, politically-neutral and mobile-first hyperlocal platform

Inclusive, multi-lingual community
and interest-based forum to
engage and stay updated about
local politics



Privacy-friendly personalization and enquiry

Tailored feeds based on user
interests and location along with
multimodal chatbot for answering
local political queries with privacy
compliance



Integrated data for local politics

Integration of external data
sources for grounded,
aggregated and tailored
responses to user queries with
neutrality

Features



Accessibility

WCAG-compliant mobile-first interface with internationalization, translation and multimodal interactions for easier access with PWA



Personalized querying and feeds

Get personalized feeds based on interests and location in privacy-friendly manner with insights on trends



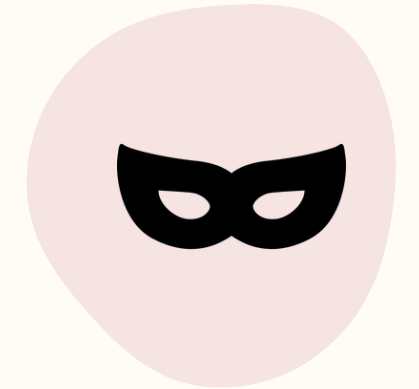
Community Engagement

Discuss recent issues and happenings with community forums tailored to inclusive, action-oriented



Unified chat interface

Privacy-friendly chatbot for local political queries based on knowledge base and external integrations

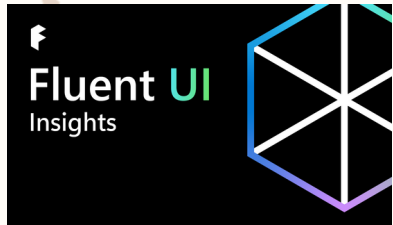


Privacy and neutrality

Automated cleanups of user data and minimal logging to combat user profiling and maintain regulatory compliance

Tech Stack

Frontend



Azure Cognitive Services
for Speech

Backend



FastAPI

LangChain



Functions App



CosmosDB for
MongoDB



Grounding with
Bing Search



Azure OpenAI

Infrastructure



Azure Content
Safety



Azure AI search



Azure SDK



Azure Container
Registry



Azure Storage
Account



Azure AI Foundry

Approach

Political Neutrality

Ensure user's political preferences are not analyzed to avoid persuasion at algorithmic level, aiding civic action at grassroots level

Privacy

The platform must not aid user profiling, collect minimal data and sanitize sensitive data before processing with external services

Responsible AI

Agents must be grounded with external knowledge sources to ensure inclusion, transparency and maintain neutrality and protect privacy

Inclusion & Accessibility

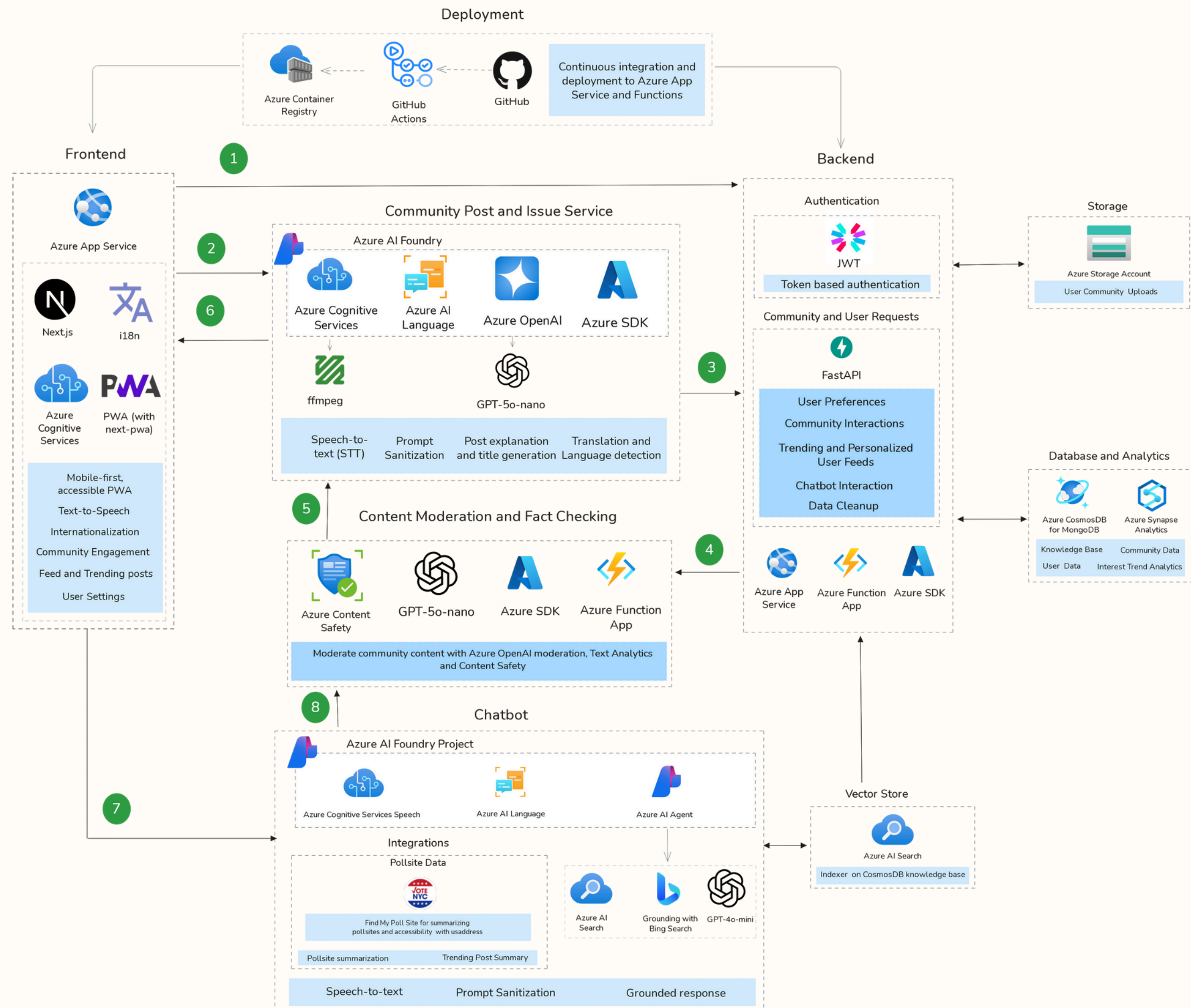
Lower barriers for underrepresented people by mobile-first approach and accessibility to engage in local politics, aiding political change

Moderation

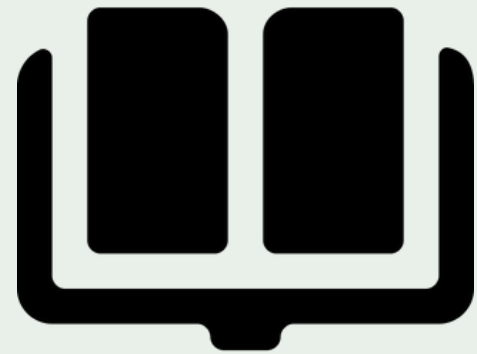
Automated moderation ensures flagging incorrect or harmful content, ensuring safety of participants

Personalization

Users must be able to access local political details by personalized feeds and chatbot in a unified interface



Impact



**Improved political
understanding**



**Increased informed
political engagement**



**Impactful community-
aided political changes**

Use Cases

Citizens

To gain deeper political understanding and engagement in local context in an inclusive and constructive manner

Local community members

To engage better with the community and orchestrate needed political actions for community's welfare

Political authorities

To understand civilian issues and work with appropriate bodies to ensure civilian morale and societal progress

Political Activists

Understand and work on active changes in political landscape by tapping into local political insights

Social Studies Researchers

To understand the correlation between civilian issues and political landscape for modeling social structures

Challenges

Streamlining moderation

Ensuring explainability of automated moderation and manual intervention for responsible AI adherence

Data and Response Quality

Development of data aggregation pipelines for comprehensive local political responses with groundedness

Accessibility

Ensuring WCAG 2.1 AAA rating and implementation of i18n and l10n for more languages spoken in NYC by content description automation

Performance

Ensuring offline operations in PWA for inclusion without compromising on performance

Compliance and political neutrality

Enforce mechanisms to prevent third-party data usage to protect user privacy and maintain political neutrality

Future Enhancements

A vertical line with four colored circles (pink, blue, green, orange) at regular intervals.

Accessibility for multi-modal content

Implement performant content description service for accessibility in multi-modal content to ensure **WCAG 2.1 AAA compliance** with i18n and l10n and simplify user experience

Support more cities than NYC and USA

Modularize local political information

aggregators to work for cities other than NYC using an agentic approach and extensive data aggregation

Performance optimization and privacy

Optimization of performance for better UX on PWA without compromising on user privacy by **minimal logging and data collection for compliance**

Federation with ActivityPub for decentralization

Integration with ActivityPub to ensure political neutrality and decentralized discussions and political coordination, aligning with spirits of **free and open source software**

Team

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Thank You



GitHub



Website